

Business, Utility, and Fire-fighting

Manufacturers worldwide stepped up to meet the burgeoning demand for business jets: swept wings and rear-mounted fuselage engines became almost essential for the type. Turboprops played their own role, offering short takeoff and landing (STOL) ability for more rugged terrain. Radial piston engines still had their place for glider towing and the like. Many aircraft of this decade remained in production for 40 to 50 years.



△ LET Z-37 Cmelák 1963

Origin Czechoslovakia
Engine 315 hp Walter M 462RF supercharged air-cooled 9-cylinder radial
Top speed 130 mph (209 km/h)

This powerful agricultural aircraft can carry 1,323 lb (600 kg) of chemicals or cargo, and was widely used in the Eastern Bloc for crop spraying. Later it became popular as a glider tug because it could tow several gliders at once.



△ PZL-104 Wilga 35 1963

Origin Poland
Engine 260 hp Ivchenko AI-14RA air-cooled 9-cylinder radial
Top speed 121 mph (195 km/h)

With more than 1,000 built in a 43-year production run, the Wilga was progressively improved. Popular for both its STOL and climb performances, it was widely used for glider towing and parachute training.



△ Pilatus PC-6/A Turbo-Porter 1961

Origin Switzerland
Engine 523 hp Turboméca Astazou IIE turboprop
Top speed 144 mph (232 km/h)

Also built in the US, the PC-6 first flew in 1959 with a piston engine. The turbine increased its power to 680 hp. Ideal for mountain use, its STOL performances include landing at 18,865 ft (5,750 m) on a glacier in Nepal.



△ de Havilland DH125 1962

Origin UK
Engine 2 x 3,000 lb (1,361 kg) thrust Bristol Siddeley Viper 520 turbojet
Top speed 522 mph (840 km/h)

Renamed Hawker Siddeley HS125, now BAe 125, this highly successful midsize business jet set the standard for its type and has been in production for more than 50 years, with more than 1,000 built.



△ de Havilland DHC6 Twin Otter 1965

Origin Canada
Engine 2 x 550 hp Pratt & Whitney PT6A-20 turboprop
Top speed 185 mph (298 km/h)

The DHC6 aircraft was available with floats, skis, or tricycle landing gear. A versatile short takeoff and landing aircraft, it reentered production in 2008 in developed form, being unbeatable for its ease of operation in remote territories.



△ Dassault Mystère 20 1963

Origin France
Engine 2 x 4,180 lb (1,894 kg) thrust General Electric CF700 turbofan
Top speed 536 mph (862 km/h)

Dassault's first business jet, also known as the Falcon 20, followed the ideal layout, with rear-mounted engines to keep the interior quiet and swept wings for speed; 508 were sold.



▷ Mitsubishi MU-2 1963

Origin Japan
Engine 2 x 575 hp Garrett TPE331-25A turboprop
Top speed 311 mph (500 km/h)

One of Japan's most successful postwar aircraft, also built in the US, the MU-2 offered high performance at low cost. Specific pilot training was required to reduce accident rates.



△ Beechcraft King Air 90 1963

Origin USA
Engine 2 x 500 hp Pratt & Whitney Canada PT6A-6 turboprop
Top speed 280 mph (450 km/h)

This market-leading eight-seat twin-turboprop entered production in 1964. The King Air 90 looked exceptionally modern for its day and has kept its lead through progressive development.